



Handout 6.16: Cook Day Duty List and Pre-Flight Check

Station: _____ Dish: _____ Day: 1 / 2 Date: _____

Page 1. The Pre-Flight Check

Twelve items. Items 1 to 8 are the teacher's, done before the bell. Items 9 to 12 are called out loud in the first four minutes.

#	Pre-flight item	Who	Checked
1	Allergy list posted at the front and at all four stations	Teacher	
2	Station bins portioned and on the right counters, nothing missing against the station cards	Teacher	
3	Station cards and poster flowcharts taped at eye level at each station	Teacher	
4	Class master flowchart on the wall with the red collision fixes visible	Teacher	
5	Pots filled with hot water and covered, burners on, oven preheating	Teacher	
6	30 plates, forks, napkins, cups, water, serving spoons, two trivets on the serving table	Teacher (Day 1), service station (Day 2)	
7	Two thermometers out, oven mitts at every station, sanitizing spray and cloths at every station	Teacher	
8	Clipboard: four Rubric 01 grids, four station check sheets, the teacher duty list	Teacher	
9	Allergy list read	Station Managers	

	aloud at each station. Anyone with an allergen in today's dishes raises a hand NOW, not at the serving table		
10	The six-step sanitation routine: hair back, sleeves up, wash hands, sanitize surfaces, clean as you go, station check before dismissal	Every student	
11	Critical path step confirmed running. "Station 1, is the water on? Station 2, is the oven at 400?"	Station Managers	
12	Every student has read their duty strip line aloud to a teammate	Every student	

Our critical path step is running: YES / NO. If NO, what we are doing about it:

The teacher says one thing when pre-flight is done: "Your plan is on the wall. In twenty-five minutes we eat. Go."

Page 2. Student Duty Strips (cut apart, one per student, keep it in your pocket)

Write your name, your role, and where you stand. Fill the four blocks from your station's flowchart.

STRIP: STATION MANAGER

Name: _____ Station: _____ **Where I stand: at the card, facing the burner**

Block	What I do
0 to 10	Read the allergy list aloud. Run pre-flight items 9 to 12. Confirm the critical path is running
10 to 25	Call the critical path at minute 10. Read the card aloud when the team stalls. Call the teacher at our teacher-call minute
25 to 34	Read the allergen box aloud to the class before the first plate. Keep the serve order: class, teammates, us
34 to 40	Run the four clean zones. Bring the station check sheet for a signature

My one line to remember: the clock is not negotiable, the presentation is.

STRIP: HEAD COOK

Name: _____ Station: _____ **Where I stand: at the burner or the oven**

Block	What I do
0 to 10	Start the critical path step first, before anything else. Water on, oven on, or beans on
10 to 25	Run the cooking steps off the card in order. Never open the oven; call the teacher
25 to 34	Carry the dish to the serving table on a trivet. Say "hot" twice
34 to 40	Zone 3: stove and oven area

STRIP: SECOND COOK

Name: _____ Station: _____ **Where I stand: next to the Head Cook**

Block	What I do
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0 to 10	Get the tools out: spoon, timer, mitts, trivet
10 to 25	Stir on the schedule the card says. Watch the timer with the Time Keeper
25 to 34	Back up the Head Cook. Refill serving spoons
34 to 40	Zone 2: sink and dishes

STRIP: PREP COOK

Name: _____ Station: _____ **Where I stand: at the ingredient bin**

Block	What I do
0 to 10	Open the bin. Check every item against the card. Set out every ingredient and tool. Tell the Station Manager if anything is missing before minute 8
10 to 25	Hand items to the cooks in card order. Open jars and packages
25 to 34	Help the Plate Builder
34 to 40	Zone 4: tools returned, bin closed, packaging in recycling

STRIP: HELPER COOK

Name: _____ Station: _____ **Where I stand: wherever the Station Manager calls**

Block	What I do
0 to 10	Sanitize the surfaces. Count the portions we need against the plan
10 to 25	Whatever the Station Manager calls. SUPPORT DUTY: if our station is ahead, go help Station _____
25 to 34	Carry, serve, pour water
34 to 40	Zone 1: tables and covers

STRIP: PLATE BUILDER

Name: _____ Station: _____ **Where I stand: at the serving table**

Block	What I do
0 to 10	Count and set 30 plates, forks, napkins, cups. Water pitchers filled
10 to 25	Trivets on the table. Serving spoons out.

	Menu and allergens written on the board
25 to 34	Plate 30 covers. Plates down at minute 29 whatever state the dish is in. Work from one end while the second Plate Builder works from the other
34 to 40	Zone 1: tables and covers

STRIP: TIME KEEPER

Name: _____ Station: _____ **Where I stand: where I can see the clock and the pot**

Block	What I do
0 to 10	Call minute 5 and minute 8 out loud. Start the timer the card says
10 to 25	Call every block out loud: "minute 10," "minute 15," "minute 20." Write the ACTUAL time next to the planned time in every block on our flowchart
25 to 34	Call minute 27 and minute 29
34 to 40	Zone 2: sink and dishes. Hand the flowchart with the actual times to the teacher at closure

STRIP: TOPPINGS CHIEF (8th student)

Name: _____ Station: _____ **Where I stand: at the finish end of the counter**

Block	What I do
0 to 10	Set out the last-layer items: cheese, parmesan, garnish, serving spoons
10 to 25	Add the last layer when the card says, not before
25 to 34	Keep the serving dish looking right. Wipe the rim of the serving bowl
34 to 40	Zone 3: surfaces

Page 3. The Two Things That Most Often Go Wrong (post this at your station)

1. THE DISH IS LATE BECAUSE THE CRITICAL PATH STEP STARTED LATE

The water is not boiling at minute 10. The oven is not at temperature when the tray is ready. Everything after it slides and the class does not eat before the bell.

Before it happens

- The critical path step is in block **0 to 5**. Not later.
- Hot tap water. Cover the pot. Do not overfill it.
- The teacher has the burners on and the oven preheating **before the bell**.
- Pre-flight item 11 confirms it out loud in the first four minutes.

When it happens (the Station Manager calls it at minute 10, not minute 20) Pick one of the three legal shortcuts:

1. **Split the batch.** Two smaller pots or two trays cook faster than one big one.
2. **Move it.** Second oven, toaster oven, or microwave for part of it.
3. **Drop the last optional step.** No second cheese layer, no garnish. Serve on time.

THE RULE: the clock is not negotiable, the presentation is. A dish served plain and on time beats a perfect dish nobody eats.

2. EVERYTHING FINISHES AT THE SAME MINUTE AND THE SERVING TABLE JAMS

Four dishes arrive at minute 27, one Plate Builder is trying to plate 30 covers, and the bell wins.

Before it happens

- The serve times are **staggered in red** on the class master flowchart. One station serves at 24, one at 26, the side and the dessert last.
- The **30 plates are already set during block one** by the service station. Nothing waits on plates.
- **Two Plate Builders**, not one, work the table from opposite ends.

When it happens

- The teacher calls “plates down at 29” at minute 24 and again at minute 27.
- At minute 29 plates go down whatever state the dish is in.
- A dish that is still not ready gets carried to the tables by its own Head Cook during the eat block.

THE RULE: the clock is not negotiable, the presentation is.



The third thing, and it is the teacher

The drain and the oven both need the teacher. If two stations need the teacher at the same minute, **both wait**. That is why the master flowchart staggers the teacher-call minutes in red. Know your minute. Do not ask early and do not ask late.

Page 4. The Station Check Sheet

Station: _____ Day: 1 / 2 Date: _____ Station Manager: _____

The station does not leave until every box is checked and the sheet is signed.

Zone 1: Tables and covers

- ☐ Every plate, fork, cup, and napkin cleared
- ☐ Tables wiped
- ☐ Chairs in

Zone 2: Sink and dishes

- ☐ Pots, pans, and bowls washed or rinsed and stacked
- ☐ Utensils washed
- ☐ Sink wiped, no standing water, no food in the drain

Zone 3: Surfaces, stove, and oven area

- ☐ Counters sanitized
- ☐ Stovetop wiped
- ☐ **Every burner OFF, confirmed by the Station Manager AND by the teacher**
- ☐ Oven off, oven area wiped, nothing left inside

Zone 4: Floor, trash, recycling, tools

- ☐ Floor swept, nothing on it, nothing wet
- ☐ Trash bagged, recycling separated
- ☐ Every tool returned to its labeled place
- ☐ Station bin closed, leftover food labeled and dated or in the trash by the two-hour rule
- ☐ Station card and flowchart still on the wall for tomorrow

The one question before the signature

Does this station look the way it looked before the bell? Circle: **YES / NOT YET**

Teacher signature: _____ **Time:** _____

Page 5. The Teacher's Minute-by-Minute Duty List (teacher copy only; carry it on the clipboard)

Minute	You do this, and only this
Before the bell	Pots filled with hot tap water, covered, on the burners. Burners on. Oven preheating. 30 plates on the serving table (Day 1). Allergy list at four places. Station bins on the counters. Clock on the screen at 0. Clipboard with four Rubric 01 grids and four station check sheets
0 to 4	Call pre-flight items 9 to 12 in order. Confirm each station out loud. Release the room
4 to 8	Stand between the two cooking stations. Check that the critical path step is actually running. Open and close the oven for anyone who needs it
8 to 14	First clipboard pass: Rubric 01 Objective 1 and the safety row for every student at the two cooking stations. One glance at the prep and service stations
14 to 18	Second clipboard pass: Rubric 01 Objective 2. Thermometer any reheated pre-cooked meat to 165 F , out loud, in front of the station
18 to 20	DRAIN DUTY. Stand at the sink. Nobody else touches a colander or a hot pot. Call "stand back" before you pour
20 to 22	Call the key check at both cooking stations: "Read me your done checklist"
22 to 24	OVEN DUTY. Pull any tray. Set it on a trivet. Say "hot" twice
24 to 27	Stand at the serving table. Call "plates down at 29." Enforce serve-others-first
27 to 29	Listen to the Station Managers read the allergen boxes. Stop the service if a box was not read
29 to 34	Sit down and eat. Ask the two table questions: "Did your flowchart hold?" and "What minute did it slip?" Write the actual times on the class master grid in a third

	color
34 to 38	Reset cue. Walk four station checks. Sign each sheet. Nobody leaves on an unsigned sheet
38 to 40	Closure: one number and one word from every student. Collect the flowchart copies with the actual times. Turn off every burner and the oven yourself and say out loud that you did
After the bell	Two-hour rule: refrigerate labeled and dated, or discard. Note on the clipboard what to change for tomorrow. Reset the pots for the next period

Day 2 changes: the pre-flight is run by Stations 3 and 4's Station Managers; the key check at minute 20 goes to Stations 3 and 4; at minute 29 to 34 add a third table question, "did yesterday's fix work," and point at the red and the third-color marks on the master grid.

Three stations instead of four: Day 1, Station 1 cooks and Stations 2 and 3 split prep and service. Day 2, Stations 2 and 3 cook and Station 1 preps and serves. Every minute above is unchanged.